

Gajino Case Study - Professional Version

CASE STUDY: Gajino

Redesigning the Digital Learning Ecosystem for 1M+ Students

Role: Director of Product Design

Duration: June 2018 – June 2020

Target Audience: K-12 Students (Ages 7–18) & Parents

Platform: Cross-platform Mobile (Android/iOS)

1. THE CHALLENGE

Gajino is the digital flagship of Gaj, the largest educational publisher in Iran. Despite having a vast content library, the initial mobile product suffered from a "Feature-First" rather than "User-First" architecture.

The Core Issues:

- * Cognitive Overload: Students across 12 grades were forced into a single, complex navigation structure.
- * Mental Model Mismatch: The app felt like a directory of files rather than a personalized study space.
- * Declining Engagement: Young learners found the interface intimidating and difficult to navigate.

2. THE STRATEGIC GOAL

As the Director of Product Design, I was tasked with transforming Gajino into a product that resonates with children and teenagers while maintaining the trust of

parents. Objective: Improve task success rates and user satisfaction by creating age-appropriate digital experiences.

3. USER RESEARCH & INSIGHTS

We conducted extensive field research, moving testing sessions from sterile office rooms to bookstores and study halls to observe natural behavior.

Key Discovery: The Age Gap * Primary School (7–11): Discovery is visual. They don't read labels; they recognize icons and colors. They need constant "fun" feedback loops. * High School (12–18): Discovery is functional. They are under high pressure and need a "Deep Work" environment with minimal distractions.

The "Desk" Epiphany: Through behavioral studies, we realized students don't organize their physical study life in folders. They have a Desk where they keep their active books and notes. This became our central design metaphor.

4. PERSONA CARDS

PERSONA A: Mani (The Visual Learner)

- Age: 9 (3rd Grade)
- Motivation: Collect stars, earn points, and see colorful characters.
- Pain Points: Too much text, getting lost in deep menus.
- Design Response: Gamified onboarding, avatar-based profile, and high-contrast visual cues.

PERSONA B: Sara (The Goal-Seeker)

- Age: 17 (11th Grade)
 - Motivation: Mastering specific subjects for the National Exam (Konkur).
 - Pain Points: Childish designs, "feature noise," and slow navigation.
 - Design Response: Minimalist "My Desk" view, dark mode, detailed performance analytics, and quick-access to practice tests.
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5. THE SOLUTION: THE "MY DESK" ECOSYSTEM

We pivoted the entire UX from a content library to a Personal Workspace.

1. Personalized Onboarding: Users choose an avatar that sets the "tone" and theme of the app based on their age group.
 2. The Digital Desk: A customizable home screen where students pin their active courses. This reduced the steps to start a lesson by 40%.
 3. Unified Learning View: Every book on the desk integrated textbooks, tutoring videos, and self-assessment quizzes into a single, seamless flow.
 4. Progress-Driven Quizzes: Introduced bite-sized tests with instant infographics, helping students visualize their strengths and mistakes.
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6. MEASURED IMPACT

The redesign led to significant improvements in both user experience and business metrics:

- +25% Improvement in Usability Test Success Rates.
 - +18% Increase in Task Success Rates (Discovery-to-Study).
 - Enhanced Retention: High adoption of the "My Desk" feature led to more frequent study sessions.
 - Market Leadership: Solidified Gajino's position as the most user-centric educational product in the Iranian market.
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7. KEY LEARNINGS

Design for education is about balancing two masters: the student (User) and the parent (Customer). Success comes from creating an interface that feels like a toy for a 7-year-old and a professional tool for a 17-year-old, all within the same brand ecosystem.